ENGLISH C2 · EXERCISE WORKBOOK

Sequence of tenses and selective backshift

Printable practice for Sequence of tenses and selective backshift in English C2. No explanations or solutions interrupt the work pages.

THIS DOCUMENT

Exercise workbook

30 learning decisions arranged in progressive stages. Write directly on the page and consult the separate answer key only after completing a stage.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Use the complete guide to understand the concept, this workbook to practise, and the answer key to diagnose each decision.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point?

OPTIONS The witness said that she had left before midnight. · The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding. · The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a proposition presented as still valid now?

OPTIONS The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding. · The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure. · The witness said that she had left before midnight.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance?

OPTIONS The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure. · The witness said that she had left before midnight. · The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The witness said that she had left before midnight.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point · a proposition presented as still valid now · a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a proposition presented as still valid now · a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance · an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance · an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point · a proposition presented as still valid now

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"The witness said that she had left before midnight." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Backshifted report / Current-validity retention / Deliberate distancing · Gap 2: an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point / a proposition presented as still valid now / a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Current-validity retention / Deliberate distancing / Backshifted report · Gap 2: a proposition presented as still valid now / a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance / an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Deliberate distancing / Backshifted report / Current-validity retention · Gap 2: a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance / an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point / a proposition presented as still valid now

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point: _____. Choose the model that expresses a proposition presented as still valid now: _____. Choose the model that expresses a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance: _____. Choose the model built with past reporting verb + past/perfect embedded tense: _____. Choose the model built with past reporting verb + present tense: _____. Choose the model built with backshift to mark reduced commitment: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The report stated that the river is highly vulnerable to flooding. · The spokesperson claimed that the system was entirely secure. · The witness said that she had left before midnight.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

04 · PRACTICE STAGE

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The witness said that she _____ before midnight. The report stated that the _____ to flooding. The spokesperson _____ entirely secure. State the full structural pattern for Backshifted report: _____. State the full structural pattern for Current-validity retention: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The witness said, “I left before midnight.”” using the Backshifted report pattern to express an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The report made a claim that remains current.” using the Current-validity retention pattern to express a proposition presented as still valid now.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The spokesperson said the system is secure, but the writer does not endorse it.” using the Deliberate distancing pattern to express a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The witness said, “I left before midnight.”” using the Backshifted report pattern to express an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Backshifted report to express an earlier embedded event viewed from a past report point, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Current-validity retention to express a proposition presented as still valid now, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Deliberate distancing to express a reported claim from which the writer maintains distance, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____

R5 · REVIEW FOCUS

Apply this decision to a new example, then justify it: Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: preserve the intended relationship between original utterance, report time and current truth status..

_____
_____

R6 · REVIEW FOCUS

Apply this decision to a new example, then justify it: Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns..

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.